PSHCE Curriculum: Student Skills Framework

This document outlines the key skills, knowledge, and attributes students are expected to develop from the whole-school PSHCE curriculum. The framework is organised into three core thematic strands: **Health and Wellbeing**, **Relationships and Sex Education**, and **Living in the Wider World**. For each topic, a set of "I can…" statements defines the practical competencies a student will gain.

Strand 1: Health and Wellbeing

This strand focuses on supporting students' mental, emotional, and physical health, equipping them with the knowledge and skills to make positive choices and build resilience.

Mental and Emotional Health

1. Understanding and Coping with Anxiety

- I can identify the physical and emotional signs of anxiety in myself and others.
- I can explain the difference between everyday worry and a more serious anxiety condition.
- I can use at least two practical strategies (e.g., breathing exercises, mindfulness) to manage feelings of anxiety.
- I can identify trusted adults and resources in and out of school where I can seek support for anxiety.

2. Stress and Relaxation

- I can explain what stress is and recognise my personal stress triggers.
- I can differentiate between positive (eustress) and negative (distress) stress.
- I can apply a range of relaxation techniques to manage stress in my daily life.

- I can create a personal wellbeing plan to promote balance and reduce stress.

3. Y9 Mental Health and Depression

- I can define mental health and explain that, like physical health, it exists on a spectrum.
- I can recognise the common symptoms of depression and understand it is a medical condition.
- I can challenge common myths and stigma surrounding mental illness.
- I can explain how and where to seek help for myself or a friend who may be struggling with their mental health.

4. Resilience

- I can define resilience and explain why it is important for navigating life's challenges.
- I can identify my own strengths and support networks that help me be resilient.
- I can describe how setbacks and failures can be opportunities for growth.
- I can apply problem-solving skills to overcome obstacles and adapt to change.

5. Y7 The Science of Happiness

- I can explain that happiness is influenced by my actions, thoughts, and connections.
- I can identify key factors that contribute to wellbeing, such as gratitude, kindness, and mindfulness.
- I can practice simple, evidence-based activities to boost my own sense of happiness.

6. Y9 New Positivity

- I can analyse the difference between genuine positivity and toxic positivity.
- I can apply strategies for developing a realistic and optimistic mindset.
- I can use positive self-talk to challenge negative thought patterns and build self-esteem.

Physical Health and Self-Care

7. Male Body Image

- I can critically analyse how media, advertising, and social media create and promote unrealistic body standards for men and boys.
- I can explain the risks associated with negative body image, including excessive exercise and use of supplements.
- I can promote body positivity and respect for diverse body types.

8. Y7 Grooming

- I can define personal hygiene and explain its importance for my health and social interactions.
- I can create and follow a personal grooming routine.
- I can demonstrate respect for my own and others' personal space and boundaries.

9. Bubble Tea & 10. What's the Big Deal About Energy Drinks

- I can analyse the nutritional content of popular drinks, including sugar and caffeine levels.
- I can explain the short-term and long-term health impacts of high sugar and caffeine consumption.
- I can make informed decisions about my drink choices to support my physical health.

11. Vapes (including Locked Test)

- I can explain what a vape is and the chemicals it contains.
- I can critically evaluate the marketing tactics used by vaping companies.
- I can analyse the known and potential health risks associated with vaping, including nicotine addiction.
- I can confidently articulate my decision regarding vaping and resist peer pressure.

12. Alcohol

- I can explain the effects of alcohol on the body and brain, particularly for teenagers.
- I can understand and apply the law regarding alcohol consumption in the UK/HK.
- I can identify the risks associated with alcohol, including binge drinking and long-term health problems.
- I can develop strategies for resisting peer pressure and making safe choices around alcohol.

13. Sexual Health Matters (STI & Contraception)

- I can identify different types of contraception and explain how they work.
- I can explain what a Sexually Transmitted Infection (STI) is and how STIs are transmitted.
- I can identify the symptoms of common STIs and know where to go for testing and treatment.
- I can explain the importance of consent and communication in any sexual relationship.

Strand 2: Relationships and Sex Education (RSE)

This strand equips students to build healthy, respectful, and safe relationships, both online and offline. It covers consent, boundaries, and how to identify and respond to harmful behaviours.

14. Peer Pressure

- I can define peer pressure and identify its different forms (spoken, unspoken, direct, indirect).
- I can analyse why people might give in to peer pressure.
- I can demonstrate a range of assertive communication techniques to resist negative peer pressure.
- I can identify situations where peer pressure can be a positive influence.

15. Relationships: What Is a Healthy Relationship?

- I can describe the key characteristics of a healthy, respectful relationship (e.g., trust, honesty, equality).
- I can identify the warning signs of an unhealthy or controlling relationship.
- I can understand the importance of setting and respecting personal boundaries.
- I can explain where to seek help if I am concerned about my own or a friend's relationship.

16. Consent

- I can define consent as a freely given, reversible, informed, enthusiastic, and specific (FRIES) agreement.
- I can explain that consent is required for every stage of a sexual encounter and can be withdrawn at any time.
- I can analyse scenarios to determine whether or not consent was given.
- I can demonstrate how to communicate my own boundaries clearly and how to respect the boundaries of others.

17. Masculinity

- I can analyse the concept of the 'Man Box' and other restrictive gender stereotypes.
- I can evaluate how societal expectations of masculinity can impact the wellbeing and behaviour of men and boys.
- I can promote a broader, healthier, and more inclusive understanding of masculinity.

18. What is Misogyny?

- I can define misogyny and provide examples of how it manifests in society.
- I can explain the link between misogynistic attitudes and violence against women and girls.
- I can challenge misogynistic language and behaviour when I see it.

19. Sexual Harassment

- I can define sexual harassment and understand that it is illegal.
- I can identify different forms of sexual harassment, both online and offline.

- I can explain the impact of sexual harassment on individuals and the wider community.
- I can describe the steps to take to report sexual harassment and support a victim.

20. Self-Awareness and Sensitivity Matter

- I can reflect on my own identity, values, and potential biases.
- I can explain the importance of empathy and considering others' perspectives and feelings.
- I can adapt my language and behaviour to be more inclusive and respectful of others.

21. Bullying or Banter? What Is and What Isn't Acceptable

- I can clearly distinguish between playful banter and hurtful bullying.
- I can analyse the impact of bullying, including its effect on mental health.
- I can identify the roles people play in a bullying situation (bully, victim, bystander, upstander).

22. Anti-Bullying and Choosing Respect

- I can take on the role of an 'upstander' by safely intervening in or reporting bullying.
- I can promote a culture of respect and kindness within my peer group and the school.
- I can access support systems for myself or others affected by bullying.

Strand 3: Living in the Wider World

This strand prepares students for life in modern society, focusing on digital citizenship, critical thinking about the world, and understanding their rights and responsibilities.

Digital Life

23. Be Careful with Social Media

- I can critically evaluate the impact of social media on my mental health, self-esteem, and sleep.
- I can manage my privacy settings to control my digital footprint.
- I can develop strategies for a healthy and balanced relationship with social media.

24. Cyberbullying

- I can define cyberbullying and identify its various forms (e.g., harassment, doxing, impersonation).
- I can explain the unique challenges of cyberbullying compared to offline bullying.
- I can use tools to block, report, and save evidence of cyberbullying.
- I can explain how to support someone who is being cyberbullied.

25. Deepfakes

- I can explain what a deepfake is and how this technology can be used to create convincing but false content.
- I can analyse the potential harms of deepfakes, including their use in misinformation and harassment.
- I can apply critical thinking skills to question the authenticity of online content.

26. Dark Web

- I can explain what the ‘Dark Web’ is and how it differs from the surface and deep web.
- I can identify the significant risks and illegal activities associated with the Dark Web.
- I can explain why it is important to stay away from these parts of the internet.

Society and Critical Thinking

27. Radicalisation

- I can define radicalisation and explain the process by which individuals can be drawn into extremist ideologies.

- I can identify the tactics used by extremist groups to recruit people, particularly online.
- I can explain the difference between holding radical views and engaging in terrorism.
- I can identify where to go for help if I am concerned about myself or someone I know.

28. Political Polarisation

- I can explain what political polarisation is and how it is amplified by social media echo chambers and filter bubbles.
- I can analyse arguments from different political viewpoints with an open mind.
- I can engage in respectful debate and discussion with people who hold different opinions.

29. Traditions and Beliefs

- I can explain how traditions, beliefs, and cultural background shape a person's identity and values.
- I can show respect for people with different beliefs and cultural practices from my own.
- I can identify shared values that connect people from different backgrounds.

30. Equality Act, Sex and Gender

- I can identify the protected characteristics under the Equality Act 2010.
- I can distinguish between the concepts of sex, gender identity, and sexual orientation.
- I can explain my rights and responsibilities regarding equality and non-discrimination.

31. Privilege

- I can define privilege and explain that it refers to unearned advantages in society.
- I can reflect on my own areas of privilege and disadvantage.
- I can explain how acknowledging privilege can help create a fairer and more empathetic society.